

MCA Question Presenter User Guide

Instructor guide for live MCA practice sessions

Purpose

MCA Question Presenter is a local desktop tool for running live MCA practice sessions. It lets an instructor screen-share questions, move through a shuffled deck, and reveal the correct answer only when ready.

Simple by design: no login, no database, no web server, no student grading, and no WordPress dependency.

Included Banks

Bank	File	Use
Chief Mate/Master Navigation	<code>samples/chief-mate-master-navigation-bank-150.csv</code>	Passage planning, position fixing, bridge management, ECDIS, weather, tides, emergencies, and current best practice from syllabus 032-73.
Chief Mate/Master Stability & Structure	<code>samples/chief-mate-master-stability-structure-bank-150.csv</code>	Advanced stability, trim, damage stability, load lines, specialised vessels, and surveys from syllabus 032-74.
OOW Navigation	<code>samples/oow-navigation-bank-150.csv</code>	Navigation, chartwork, lights, signals, rules, and related OOW practice.
OOW Stability	<code>samples/oow-stability-bank-150.csv</code>	Stability, loading, buoyancy, free surface, and related OOW practice.

The OOW Navigation bank loads automatically when the app starts. Use **Load Selected** to switch to any other bundled bank.

Install On Windows

Use the Windows build artifact provided by the instructor or course organizer. The learner does not need Python, Git, GitHub login, or command-line setup.

1. Download the **MCA-Question-Presenter-Windows** zip file.
2. Right-click the zip file and choose **Extract All...**
3. Open the extracted folder.
4. Double-click **MCA Question Presenter.exe**.

If Windows SmartScreen appears, choose **More info**, then **Run anyway** only if the file came directly from the instructor or the official course channel.

Start A Teaching Session

1. Launch the app by double-clicking **MCA Question Presenter.exe**.
2. Use the private **Instructor controls** window to drive the session.
3. Share only the **MCA Question Display** window in Zoom, Teams, or Google Meet.
4. Press **Next** to show the first question.
5. Discuss the question, then press **Reveal / Hide** when ready.
6. Press **Next** to continue.

Instructor Controls

Control	What It Does
Load CSV...	Open a custom CSV question bank from your computer.
Show Display	Bring the presentation window back to the front.
Topic	Filter the current bank by <code>topic_tag</code> .
Previous	Return to the previous question.
Next	Move to the next question.
Reveal / Hide	Show or hide the correct answer.
Reshuffle	Randomize the current topic or full bank again.
Load Selected	Load one of the bundled banks.

Keyboard Shortcuts

Right arrow

Next question

Left arrow

Previous question

Space or Enter

Reveal or hide answer

F11 / Escape

Toggle or leave fullscreen

Recommended Screen-Share Setup

Keep **Instructor controls** private and share **MCA Question Display** with students. If the display window disappears behind other windows, click **Show Display**. For a cleaner lesson view, press **F11** while the display window is active.

Upload A Custom CSV

Use **Load CSV...** when you want to teach from your own question bank instead of the bundled question banks.

1. Prepare the question bank as a .csv file.
2. Save the file using UTF-8 encoding if your spreadsheet app offers an encoding choice.
3. Open **MCA Question Presenter.exe**.
4. Click **Load CSV...** in the **Instructor controls** window.
5. Select your CSV file.
6. The app loads the bank, shuffles the active questions, and shows the first question immediately.

If the file has `topic_tag` values, they appear in the **Topic** drop-down after the CSV loads. Choose a topic to teach only that subset, or choose **All** to use the full bank.

Question Bank Format

Required columns:

```
question_text,option_a,option_b,option_c,option_d,correct_option
```

Recommended full format:

```
portal,question_text,option_a,option_b,option_c,option_d,correct_option,topic_tag,is_active,sort_order
```

Column	Required	What To Put In It
question_text	Yes	The question shown to students.
option_a	Yes	Answer choice A.
option_b	Yes	Answer choice B.
option_c	Yes	Answer choice C.
option_d	Yes	Answer choice D.
correct_option	Yes	The letter of the correct answer: A, B, C, or D.
portal	No	A label for the bank or course, for example oow.
topic_tag	No	Topic filter name, for example colregs, chartwork, or stability.
is_active	No	Use 1 for active questions; use 0, false, no, inactive, or blank to skip a row.
sort_order	No	Number used for stable ordering before the app shuffles the session.

Example CSV:

```
portal,question_text,option_a,option_b,option_c,option_d,correct_option,topic_tag,is_active,sort_order
oow,"What does a vessel at anchor display by day?","One black ball","Two black balls","A black cylinder","A red cone","A","colregs",1,1
```

- correct_option must be A, B, C, or D.
- question_text and all four answer options must not be blank.
- topic_tag controls the topic filter.
- sort_order controls the stable load order before shuffling.
- is_active values of 0, false, no, inactive, or blank are skipped.
- Extra columns are allowed, but the app ignores them.
- If a question or answer contains a comma, keep the value inside double quotes.

Troubleshooting

Problem	Fix
Windows blocks the app on first launch	Choose More info then Run anyway , but only for the instructor-provided build.
Nothing happens after double-clicking	Extract the zip first, then run MCA Question Presenter.exe from the extracted folder.
The selected bank has no questions	Check that is_active is not blank, 0, false, no, or inactive.
A CSV will not load	Confirm all required columns exist, every row has A-D options, and correct_option contains only A, B, C, or D.
Topics do not appear	Add values to the optional topic_tag column, then reload the CSV.
The wrong answer is highlighted	Check the row's correct_option value.
Students can see the controls	Share only the MCA Question Display window.

Scope

This app is for live teaching and practice. It does not record student answers, calculate scores, manage course access, or run online exams.